
PRODUCTBEACON

Cyber Weekly Summary · 12 September 2026

Yohay Etsion

Managing Director, ProductBeacon

ProductBeacon Research

The main stories

- **Zscaler launched Agentic SOC.** The company says AI agents handle investigations and response, and the product is available globally.
- **SailPoint grew; its shares fell.** Annual recurring revenue rose 25% to \$1.231 billion. Shares closed down 1.18%.
- **Keyfactor and Kiteworks completed acquisitions.** Cofide adds machine identity; Bonfy.AI adds data classification and enforcement, according to their buyers.
- **The EU cybersecurity agency gained restricted model access.** It received Claude Mythos 5 and GPT-6 Astra access, but not Mythos 5.1.
- **Cylake raised \$245 million before beta.** The convertible note takes total funding to \$290 million.
- **Proofpoint's reported talks to buy Varonis remain unconfirmed.** Analyst price targets changed; there is still no confirmed agreement.

Our view: established security vendors are reducing the capabilities AI startups can claim as unique. Zscaler's launch is the clearest example this week.

Security operations

Zscaler launches AI agents for investigations and response

- Zscaler says Agentic SOC is available globally. The company says its agents handle alert triage, root-cause investigation, verdicts and response.
- The company says it combines Anthropic and OpenAI models with its security data and automated remediation.
- According to Zscaler, its specialists and Red Canary provide human threat hunting alongside the agents.
- **Why it matters:** AI-native startups now face an established vendor offering these capabilities. Customer results will determine how well the product delivers.

Source: *Zscaler*.

CrowdStrike acquires XM Cyber technology assets

- CrowdStrike completed the purchase of **the technology assets of XM Cyber Ltd.** on 8 September.
- It paid **2,118,022 Class A shares** to a Schwarz Group affiliate.

- The 11 September filing registers those shares for resale. CrowdStrike receives no proceeds from a resale.
- **Wipro partnership:** the companies launched a Falcon-based security command centre covering endpoint, cloud, exposure management and AI security.
- **VAST Data partnership:** the vendors say VAST InsightEngine and Falcon Guardian will help protect enterprise AI data infrastructure.
- CrowdStrike also named a North American partner group for Project QuiltWorks. Commercial terms and a member count were not disclosed.

Sources: *SEC filing*, *CrowdStrike*, *HPCwire* and *Business Wire*.

Identity

SailPoint reports 25% recurring-revenue growth

SailPoint's fiscal second-quarter results cover the three months ended 31 July.

Measure	Result
Annual recurring revenue	\$1.231 billion , up 25%
Revenue	\$309 million , up 17%
Software-as-a-service recurring revenue	\$847 million , up 36%
AI-driven recurring revenue	More than \$70 million
Contracted revenue not yet recognised	\$1.9 billion , up 30%
Adjusted diluted earnings per share	+\$0.09
Statutory net loss per share	-\$0.09
Full-year recurring-revenue guidance	\$1,375–1,385 million
Closing share price	\$17.58 , down 1.18%

- Annual recurring revenue is the yearly value of active subscription contracts.
- The company reported growth across its main revenue measures. Its share price fell after the results.
- SailPoint's stated AI recurring-revenue target is at least **\$800 million in fiscal 2029**.

Sources: *SailPoint results*, *SimplyWall.st*.

Keyfactor completes its Cofide acquisition

- Keyfactor says Cofide gives software workloads and AI agents short-lived cryptographic identities, replacing static passwords and long-lived tokens.
- Cofide will join the Keyfactor Trust Control Plane. Co-founder Matt Bates joins Keyfactor.
- The acquisition is complete. The price was not disclosed.

Source: *Keyfactor*.

Okta announces controls for people, workloads and agents

- Okta announced new tools for managing permissions, privileged access and identity threats.
- The planned features cover AWS permissions, databases, Kubernetes, network devices, build pipelines and AI agents.
- **Availability:** governance features are planned for early access in Q4; privileged-access features for general availability in Q1.
- Okta also introduced near-field-communication authentication for frontline workers. Its Oktane conference runs **23–24 September**.

Source: *Okta*.

Smaller vendors add agent identity controls

- **Ory:** Agent Security is generally available. Ory says it checks identity when an agent calls a tool or takes an action.
- Ory's claim to offer the first such platform is contested; CrowdStrike, Okta, Keyfactor and Astrix offer adjacent capabilities.
- **Orchid Security:** trade reporting describes identity-drift detection and kill switches that stop agents taking unauthorised actions.

Sources: *Ory*, *Help Net Security*.

Kevin Mandia joins Amazon's board

- Mandia joins Amazon's Audit and Security Committees.
- He founded Mandiant and led its \$5.4 billion sale to Google. He now runs AI-security startup Armadin and invests through Ballistic Ventures.
- **Why it matters:** Amazon gains a security operator with experience in major breach investigations. Armadin is also worth following.

Sources: *Amazon filing*, *CNBC*.

Data security

Kiteworks acquires Bonfy.AI

- Kiteworks says Bonfy.AI classifies sensitive data and enforces policy as it moves through email, file sharing, applications, repositories and AI agents.
- Kiteworks will integrate the product into its Data Control Plane and continue selling it separately.
- Kiteworks reports **eight acquisitions in under five years**. Insight Partners and Sixth Street back the company.
- The price was not disclosed. Calcalist's estimate of tens of millions of dollars remains unconfirmed.

Source: *Kiteworks*, *Calcalist* and *PE Hub*.

SecureSky acquires Soveren

- SecureSky says Soveren's data discovery and classification will become part of its exposure-management and managed-detection platform.
- The price was not disclosed.
- **Why it matters:** a broader security platform is absorbing data-posture management. That complicates the prediction that data-posture vendors will do the buying.

Sources: *PR Newswire*, *Dealroom*.

Nightfall adds controls for AI tool calls

- Nightfall opened **early access** to MCP Gateway. The company says it checks policy before AI agents execute tool calls.
- Nightfall says agents never handle raw credentials, and high-risk calls such as database deletions can be stopped before execution.
- Nightfall says every call is audited without retaining prompt or response content.
- Two companion products protect command-line data transfers and identify unreviewed Model Context Protocol servers.
- **All three are early access.** Nightfall names Cursor, Claude Code, Visual Studio Code and Claude Cowork among the supported environments.

Source: *Nightfall AI*.

Proofpoint expands insider investigations

- Proofpoint's Human Communications Intelligence agents are available now as an add-on for insider-threat investigations, according to SecurityBrief Australia.
- Investigators can consider employees' exchanges with copilots, AI applications and agents.

- A separate **Prism Investigator connection to Microsoft 365 is planned for Q4 2026**. It would retrieve email, Teams messages and files during investigations.
- SecurityBrief quotes Proofpoint executive Harry Labana. No source connects these product changes to the reported Varonis talks.

Source: *SecurityBrief Australia*.

Other business moves

- **Everfox:** its threat-protection API is available to US federal developers through OneGov and reseller immixGroup, the company says.
- **Orient Technologies:** trade reports describe a three-year Securonix contract worth about **\$3.15 million**.
- Orient's planned additional investment would bring the commitment to roughly **\$5 million**, including around **100 cybersecurity hires**.
- Orient supplied those figures. They are reported in trade press, rather than a Securonix release or stock-exchange filing.
- **Fortinet:** the company says Gartner named it a Leader in the Hybrid Mesh Firewall Magic Quadrant, an adjacent market to secure edge.

Sources: *Everfox, Trade Brains, Enterprise Times India and Fortinet's GlobeNewswire release*.

AI security and funding

EU cybersecurity agency gains restricted model access

- The European Union Agency for Cybersecurity gained access to Anthropic's **Claude Mythos 5** and OpenAI's **GPT-6 Astra**.
- European Commission spokesman Thomas Regnier confirmed the access. It is the first EU institution admitted to Anthropic's controlled-access programme.
- **Mythos 5.1 is excluded.** Negotiations reportedly took three months, complicated by US export controls.
- **Why it matters:** access expanded to one institution. This does not establish wider public access.

Sources: *Euronews, Reuters*.

Cylake raises \$245 million before beta

- Cylake raised **\$245 million through a convertible note**, bringing total funding to **\$290 million**.
- Investors include Lightspeed Venture Partners, Picture Capital and Redpoint Ventures. Greylock led its earlier **\$45 million** seed round.

- Nir Zuk, founder of Palo Alto Networks, co-founded Cylake with Wilson Xu and SentinelOne co-founder Ehud Shamir.
- **Beta is planned for late 2026; general availability for 2027.** The platform is designed to run on customer premises or in private cloud.
- **Why it matters:** investors are committing substantial funding before the product reaches beta. The convertible note postpones setting a valuation.

Source: *Calcalist/CTech*.

Cymphony and HelmGuard raise funding

- **Cymphony raised \$25 million** in a Series A co-led by Sequoia Capital and SMBC Fin Atlas Beyond Fund.
- Its reported valuation exceeded **\$100 million**; total funding reached **\$30 million**.
- Cymphony focuses on security and permissions when AI agents act for employees.
- **HelmGuard raised \$7.3 million** in a seed round co-led by Infinity Ventures and Frontline, aiming to automate compliance work with AI agents.

Sources: *TechCrunch, The Next Web*.

Agent-control standard gains OWASP backing

- Zenity published details of the Agent Control Standard's adoption by the OWASP GenAI Security Project, announced on **1 September**.
- The standard describes where a separate guardian can permit, deny or modify an AI agent's actions.
- **It remains version 0.1 public preview.** Zenity says deny-and-modify enforcement across the two agent protocols is two major versions away.
- **Why it matters:** vendors have a common direction for agent controls, but the full enforcement mechanism is still planned.

Source: *Zenity Labs*.

Acquisitions at a glance

Buyer	Acquisition	Status	Consideration
Keyfactor	Cofide	Completed	Undisclosed
Kiteworks	Bonfy.AI	Completed	Undisclosed
SecureSky	Soveren	Acquisition announced	Undisclosed

Buyer	Acquisition	Status	Consideration
CrowdStrike	XM Cyber technology assets	Completed	2,118,022 Class A shares
Surfshark Group	Majority stake in Optery	Acquired	Undisclosed

Optery remains a standalone business. Among these acquisitions, only CrowdStrike disclosed what it paid, in shares rather than a cash price.

Sources: company announcements and the CrowdStrike filing; [Surfshark on Optery](#).

Prediction updates

Our predictions, checked against recent evidence. These are our interpretations.

Prediction	Our assessment
Large platforms win across data security and broader security platforms	Supported
Identity and security operations converge through machine and agent accounts	Supported
Data-posture platforms absorb data-loss prevention	Buying trend supported; replacement not established
Bundled products squeeze specialists in the mid-market	Supported within that scope
AI tool-call security becomes a distinct category	Now mixed, previously weakened
AI-native challengers retain a distinctive capability advantage	Weakened
Standalone insider-risk brands are absorbed into broader platforms	Unchanged

1. Large platforms win across both markets

- Microsoft, Palo Alto Networks, CrowdStrike and Cisco continue broadening their offerings through products, acquisitions and investment.
- Earlier moves include Palo Alto's August Embrace and September Console acquisitions, Cisco's August Teleport investment, and Microsoft's broader Purview controls.
- **Our assessment remains supported:** the platforms are strengthening their positions across both markets. Their share-price declines do not establish weaker competitive positions.

2. Identity moves toward machine and agent accounts

- Keyfactor's Cofide purchase follows Cyera's **\$1 billion Oasis Security acquisition on 3 September**, now renamed Cyera Identity.
- Okta, CrowdStrike, Ory and Orchid are adding controls for workloads and AI agents.
- **Our assessment remains supported:** these moves connect identity controls with security operations, with machine accounts driving the change.
- A large acquisition focused on conventional employee login, or a standalone vendor scaling on that alone, would challenge this prediction.

3. Data-posture platforms absorb loss prevention

- Kiteworks/Bonfy.AI adds to earlier purchases such as Nasuni/DryvIQ in August.
- **The buying trend is supported.** But no disclosed enterprise replacement win or analyst reclassification yet establishes that loss prevention has become a subordinate capability.
- SecureSky/Soveren points the other way: a broader exposure platform is absorbing data-posture management.

4. Bundles squeeze the mid-market

- Okta added agent single sign-on to its core product at no extra cost in August. Cato introduced pooled small-business licensing in early September.
- Zscaler adds security operations to its platform. Its undisclosed separate price does not mean the product is free.
- **Our assessment remains supported for the mid-market and new deployments.** The resulting loss of specialist revenue has not been established.
- Specialists still grow: SailPoint reported 25% recurring-revenue growth; Netskope reported 27% in its September results. Established enterprise accounts remain a separate question.

5. AI tool-call security becomes a distinct category

- Nightfall's early-access product follows Operant AI's semantic firewall, generally available since **27 August**.
- **Our assessment improves from weakened to mixed.** Two dedicated products support the prediction; analyst recognition of this distinct category is still missing.
- The same capabilities also appear within larger platforms. Dedicated products and bundled features are developing together.
- Nightfall remains early access, and the OWASP standard remains a preview. The prediction runs through the first half of 2027.

6. AI-native challengers retain a distinctive advantage

- The test is whether an established vendor releases a credible agentic layer that removes the challengers' distinctive capability advantage.

- **Our assessment is now weakened:** we read Zscaler's globally available Agentic SOC as meeting that test.
- Zscaler's capabilities remain company claims. Availability does not establish effectiveness or mean startups will lose.
- The **Agentic SOC Alliance remains at 15 members**; the **AI Proving Grounds Consortium remains at 6 organisations**.

7. Standalone insider-risk brands are absorbed

- **Our assessment is unchanged:** seven weeks without a recorded insider-risk acquisition does not support a new absorption verdict.
- Proofpoint is adding insider-investigation features to its broader platform. Cyberhaven's promised Claude Enterprise connector still has no launch announcement.
- Evidence of standalone vendors' independence has weakened, but fewer announcements do not mean those vendors are being acquired.

*Supporting sources: the company reports above and **full source notes**, including earlier announcements used to assess the predictions.*

Stories to watch

Proofpoint and Varonis

- Reported acquisition talks remain unconfirmed. Cantor Fitzgerald's latest note says no final agreement has been reached.
- Cantor reiterated a **\$55** target; Needham raised its target to **\$55 from \$50**. Those are analyst views, not confirmation of a deal.
- **Watch for:** a company announcement or definitive agreement.

Sources: Reuters, Bloomberg Law and Investing.com.

Accenture's proposed security acquisitions

- Accenture's approximately **\$4.175 billion** agreements to buy Dragos, runZero and NetRise remain awaiting a public completion announcement.
- Dragos says integration follows regulatory sign-off.

Sources: Accenture and Dragos.

Cyberhaven's Claude Enterprise connector

- Cyberhaven promised the connector for **August**. No launch announcement or revised date has been found.
- Its existing Claude Code plug-in is a separate product.

Source: Cyberhaven.

Microsoft previews

- Purview's protection for non-Microsoft apps remains in preview, with general availability expected by late October.
- Project Perception remains limited to a small, invitation-only customer group. No general-availability date or price has been announced.

Source: Microsoft Learn.

Forcepoint certification

- Forcepoint's secure-edge offering is listed as **FedRAMP Certified** on the current marketplace.

Source: FedRAMP Marketplace.

Coming events

- **Cisco and Splunk, 14–17 September:** security and AI announcements could show how established platforms are extending their offerings.
- **Okta Oktane, 23–24 September:** watch for firmer availability details on the new identity controls.
- **AI Proving Grounds Consortium, 24 September:** its virtual event on governing AI at scale is confirmed.

Sources

The [full source notes](#) link each reported development to company announcements, regulatory filings or named publications. Earlier announcements supporting the prediction updates are included there.